From ONE to 1,733,906,375: Christie's 2020 in numbers

In this challenging year Christie's has embraced new digital technologies to connect its clients with our sales across the globe — maintaining strong results while making auction history

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16 December 2020

ONE

On 10 July, Christie's made auction history with *ONE*, a live-streamed, four-hour marathon auction that took place in consecutive sessions in Hong Kong, Paris, London and New York. Using innovative streaming technology, the sale of 20th-century art topped $420 million, including more than $46 million for a late-career Roy Lichtenstein, *Nude with Joyous Painting* (1994).

Open link https://www.christies.com/lotfinder/paintings/roy-lichtenstein-nude-with-joyous-painting-6269993-details.aspx?from=searchresults&intObjectID=6269993

Roy Lichtenstein, *Nude with Joyous Painting*, 1994. Oil and Magna on canvas. 70 x 53 in (177.8 x 134.6 cm). Property from an Important Private American Collection. Sold for $46,242,500 on 10 July 2020 at Christie's in New York. Artwork: © Estate of Roy Lichtenstein/DACS 2020

Building on the unprecedented success of *ONE*, in October Christie's launched *20th Century: London to Paris*, a dynamic, cross-channel conversation between two culturally vibrant cities, followed in December by *20th Century: Hong Kong to New York*, a relay sale live-streamed consecutively from Christie's salerooms in Hong Kong and New York.

Alighiero Boetti, *Mappa (Map)*, 1984 (detail). Sold for £1,702,500 on 22 October 2020 at Christie's in London. Artwork: © Alighiero Boetti / DACS 2020

'This hybrid-format concept sale is a way to adapt and innovate,' commented Christie's chief executive officer, Guillaume Cerutti. 'We wanted to stage something that accommodates the current situation and serves our clients, wherever they are and however they wish to participate.'

2

The second sale offering works from the collection of Paul Destribats, the Paris-based bibliophile who documented the 20th-century avant-garde, realised €2,171,425, selling 100 per cent by lot and 100 per cent by value. The top lot was Iliazd's *Maquette de La Maigre*, which sold for €162,500, more than

double its low estimate.

6

The date in October when STAN, one of the most complete *T-rexes* ever found, sold for $31,847,500 — more than five times its low estimate.

Open link https://www.christies.com/lotfinder/fossils-minerals/tyrannosaurus-rex-south-dakota-usa-6283836-details.aspx?from=salesummery&intobjectid=6283836

A male *Tyrannosaurs rex* from the Hell Creek Formation, 16 metres below the K-T boundary. Maastrichtian, Late Cretaceous (circa 67 million years ago). 37 x 13 x 6 ft (1128 x 396 x 183 cm). Sold for $31,847,500 in the 20th Century Evening Sale on 6 October at Christie's in New York

Open link https://www.christies.com/lotfinder/fossils-minerals/tyrannosaurus-rex-south-dakota-usa-6283836-details.aspx?from=salesummery&intobjectid=6283836

Unearthed in 1987, less than a century after the existence of *Tyrannosaurus rex* had first become known, STAN represents what James Hyslop, head of Christie's Science & Natural History department, described as 'one of the best specimens ever discovered'.

8

Figures populate Marie Spartali Stillman's *The Enchanted Garden*, which sold for £874,500, nearly triple its low estimate, in a dedicated single-owner sale of works from The Joe Setton Collection. Among the eight figures are Messer Ansaldo, a nobleman in Udine, and Madonna Dianora, the virtuous wife of another man. The source material for the magnificent watercolour, painted in 1889 at the height of Stillman's career, is the fifth story on the 10th (and last) day of Boccaccio's *Decameron.*

19

Charities around the world supporting communities impacted by the coronavirus pandemic benefited from the sale of 26 of photographer Mark Seliger's most celebrated portraits.

Open link https://www.christies.com/features/Mark-Seliger-10483-7.aspx

Mark Seliger: RADArt4Aid, a special fundraising collaboration for Covid-19 relief produced in partnership with Mark Seliger and RAD (Red Carpet Advocacy), totalled $232,375, more than twice the pre-sale estimate. Every lot was sold, with 100 per cent of the proceeds going to the designated beneficiaries.

22

Young, emerging and mid-career artists from across Africa and its diaspora featured in *SAY IT LOUD* (31 July-18 August), an online selling exhibition presented by Christie's in collaboration with the Harlem Arts Alliance and curator and art advisor Destinee Ross-Sutton.

28.86

The weight in carats of this spectacular Type IIA D colour diamond ring, which sold at Christie's for $2,115,000, setting a world record for the most expensive jewel sold in an online-only auction.

Open link https://onlineonly.christies.com/s/jewels-online/spectacular-diamond-ring-28-86-carats-153/88746

A spectacular diamond ring of 28.86 carats. Sold for $2,115,000, 30 June 2020, Online

50

Large-scale artworks to browse and bid for in *Dream Big*, a summer online private selling exhibition featuring sculptures from across the world by the likes of Alexander Calder, Jeff Koons, Niki de Saint Phalle and Fernando Botero.

53

Exceptional pieces were offered online from the collection of philanthropist and couture collector Susan Casden.

Among the treasures was a Hermès matte ébène salvator lizard retourné Kelly 25 with ruthenium hardware, which sold for $37,500. Offered, too, was a Hermès fuchsia niloticus crocodile sellier Kelly with palladium hardware, which sold for $56,250, nearly triple its low estimate.

Open link https://onlineonly.christies.com/s/handbags-accessories-online-new-york-edition/matte-ebene-salvator-lizard-retourne-kelly-25-ruthenium-hardware-40/104969

A matte ébène salvator lizard retourné Kelly 25 with ruthenium hardware, Hermès, 2005, from the collection of Susan Casden. Sold for $37,500, 10 December 2020, Online

Open link https://onlineonly.christies.com/s/handbags-accessories-online-new-york-edition/shiny-fuchsia-niloticus-crocodile-sellier-kelly-25-palladium-hardware-25/104917

A shiny fuchsia niloticus crocodile sellier Kelly 25 with palladium hardware, Hermès, 2005, from the collection of Susan Casden. Sold for $56,250, 10 Dec 2020, Online

100

On 15 November 2020, Wayne Thiebaud — the American artist best-known for his still lifes of pies, pastries and other tempting treats — turned 100. Just four months earlier, *Four Pinball Machines* set a new wold auction record for the artist when it sold for $19,135,000 in Christie's *ONE* sale.

Open link https://www.christies.com/lotfinder/Lot/wayne-thiebaud-b-1920-four-pinball-machines-6269998-details.aspx

Wayne Thiebaud (b. 1920), *Four Pinball Machines*, 1962. Sold for $19,135,000 on 10 July 2020 at Christie's in New York. Artwork: © Wayne Thiebaud/VAGA at ARS, NY and DACS, London 2020

626

Lots to choose from in *The Private Collection of Ben Ichinose*, an single-owner online sale that realised $2,340,800.

The sale included the finest wines from Bordeaux, Burgundy, Mosel and Madeira, alongside the greatest assemblage of mature Californian wines to appear at auction. Offered, too, were large formats of 1961 and 1964 Bollinger and an impressive selection of Château Lafite-Rothschild, featuring a 1961 imperial.

760

The width in centimetres of a breathtaking mosaic by Zao Wou-Ki and mosaic artist Dominique Hideux, which sold for €1,400,000 in *Le jardin secret de Paul Haim*, a dedicated single-owner sale that totalled €20,589,375, selling 100 per cent by lot and 100 per cent by value.

Open link https://www.christies.com/lotfinder/lot/zao-wou-ki-et-dominique-hideux-6282976-details.aspx?from=salesummery&intObjectID=6282976

Zao Wou-Ki (1920-2013) and Dominique Hideux, *Sans titre*, 1984. Ceramic on concrete wall. 74⅘ x 298¼ in (192 x 760 cm). Sold for €1,400,000 at Christie's in Paris. Artwork: © DACS 2020

The work, formerly installed in the Basque sculpture garden of Paul and Jeannette Haim, was commissioned by Haim after he had visited the Houston home of the great collector Dominique de Menil and encountered a mosaic evoking Monet's *Water Lilies.*

1623

Published in 1623, seven years after Shakespeare's death, the First Folio brought together the author's collected plays for the first time. Only five complete copies of the First Folio remained in private hands, and in October Christie's offered the first complete copy to come to market in almost two decades. It sold for $9,978,000, more than double its low estimate, in *The Exceptional Sale* at Christie's in New York.

1932

Open link https://www.christies.com/LotFinder/lot_details.aspx?intObjectID=6252179

Tamara de Lempicka, *Portrait de Marjorie Ferry*, 1932. Oil on canvas. 39⅜ x 25⅝ in (100 x 65 cm). Sold for £16,380,000 on 5 February 2020 at Christie's in London. Artwork: © Tamara de Lempicka Estate, LLC / ADAGP, Paris and DACS, London 2020

The year Tamara de Lempicka painted this dazzling portrait of Marjorie Ferry, a British-born, cabaret singer performing in Paris. It sold for £16,380,000 on 5 February at Christie's in London, setting a new world auction record for the artist.

1977

Barbara de Kwiatkowski was the 1970s It Girl —'the embodiment of a decade', as her friend, *Interview* magazine's Bob Colacello put it. But behind the glamour was a discerning collector who owned extraordinary things, including four unique Warhol polaroids of Barbara dating to 1977, which sold for $21,250 at Christie's in New York.

Open link https://www.christies.com/lotfinder/Lot/andy-warhol-19281987-barbara-allen-1977-6225284-details.aspx

Andy Warhol (1928-1987), *Barbara Allen*, 1977. Four polaroid prints. Each image: 3¾ x 3 in (9.5 x 7.6 cm). Each sheet: 4¼ x 3½ in (10.9 x 8.8 cm). Sold for $21,250 on 2 October 2019 at Christie's in New York. Artwork: © 2020 The Andy Warhol Foundation for the Visual Arts, Inc. / Licensed by DACS, London

Warhol is thought to have used these snapshots as the starting point for an uncharacteristic pencil sketch of his muse, which fetched $37,500 on 3 December at Christie's in New York. Additional treasures from The Collection of Barbara Allen de Kwiatkowski include Warhol's *Mao* (1973) and an oval, brilliant-cut 10.59-carat diamond purchased as an anniversary present by her husband, Henryk de Kwiatkowski, from Harry Winston.

2,400

The estimated age in years of a magnificent pair of gold- and silver-inlaid bronze chariot fittings, likely to have been made for an emperor of the Eastern Zhou dynasty.

Open link https://www.christies.com/lotfinder/Lot/a-rare-and-magnificent-pair-of-gold-6285204-details.aspx

A rare and magnificent pair of gold and silver-inlaid bronze chariot fittings, Eastern Zhou dynasty, 4th-3rd century BC. 10¼ in (26 cm) long. Sold for £1,522,500 on 3 November 2020 at Christie's in London

Intricately decorated and cast in the shape of a dragon pursuing a phoenix, the archaic bronzes would have been used to support a crossbow — with the charioteer using the dragon's mouth to draw the string of the bow. The chariot fittings — described by specialist Cecilia Zi as 'museum-quality' — soared above the low estimate of £600,000 before selling for £1,522,500 at Christie's in London.

5033

The reference of the Patek Philippe titanium automatic 'Cathedral' minute repeating wristwatch that sold for HK$15,125,000 at Christie's Hong Kong in July.

Open link https://www.christies.com/lotfinder/watches/patek-philippe-a-unique-and-highly-important-6260061-details.aspx?from=salesummery&intObjectID=6260061

A unique and highly important titanium automatic 'Cathedral' minute repeating annual calendar wristwatch by Patek Philippe. Sold for HK$15,125,000 on 13 July 2020 at Christie's in Hong Kong

The timepiece was offered from The Titanium Collection, the most valuable single-owner collection of watches of this kind ever offered in Asia, and set a new world record for the reference.

287,500

The price, in pounds sterling, achieved by Marina Abramović's *The Life* (2018-19), the first Mixed Reality work to be offered at auction. The groundbreaking artwork, which premiered at London's Serpentine Galleries in February 2019, was acquired by the Faurschou Foundation, an art institution headquartered in Copenhagen with permanent exhibition spaces in Beijing and New York — the price setting a new world record for the artist at auction.

1,650,000

On 25 September a magnificent pair of 18th-century Chinese 'Boys Jars', which are thought to have been purchased by America's original retail magnate, John Wanamaker, around 1907, sold for $1,650,000, more than double its low estimate.

Open link https://www.christies.com/lotfinder/lot/a-very-rare-pair-of-famille-rose-6276577-details.aspx?from=salesummary&intObjectID=6276577&lid=1

A very rare pair of famille rose 'boys' jars and covers, Qianlong six-character seal marks in underglaze blue and of the period (1736-1795). 11¼ in (28.5 cm) high. Sold for $1,650,000 on 25 September 2020 at Christie's in New York

Decorated with *famille rose* enamels, they feature scenes of young boys at play — some waving flags, others playing instruments, one riding a hobby horse. Although similar vases can be found in the Palace Museum in Beijing, it is exceptionally rare to find two imperial examples together — and, crucially, with their original covers.

28,650,000

Offered from the collection of Edsel & Eleanor Ford House — in which it had resided for more than 80 years — *Nature morte avec pot au lait, melon et sucrier* (c. 1900-1906) realised $28,650,000, setting a new world auction record for a watercolour by Paul Cézanne.

170,170,000

The price, in Hong Kong dollars, achieved by Sanyu's *Goldfish* (1930s-40s) in a stand-alone single-lot auction at Christie's Hong Kong on 2 December. Selling for HK$170,170,000, it established a record for an animal-subject work by the artist.

Open link https://www.christies.com/lotfinder/paintings/sanyu-goldfish-6297113-details.aspx?from=salesummery&intobjectid=6297113

Sanyu (Chang Yu, 1895-1966), *Goldfish*, 1930s-1940s. Oil on canvas. 73.8 x 50.2 cm (29 x 19¾ in). Sold for HK$170,170,000 on 2 December 2020 at Christie's in Hong Kong

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573,900,000

The amount, in dollars, achieved by New York's two-part Fall 20th Century auction season — the combined total of the early October 2020 sale series ($387.2 million) and December 20th Century series ($186,618,100/ £139,520,175).

The late-Fall 20th Century marquee week opened on 2 December with *20th Century: Hong Kong to New York*, the relay sale live-streamed consecutively from Christie's salerooms in Hong Kong and New York. A highlight of the autumn auction series in Hong Kong, it realised $119,273,225 / HK$920,350,057 — selling 90 per cent by lot and 97 per cent by value.

Henri de Toulouse-Lautrec's *Pierreuse* (1889) produced the top price of the sale at $9,062,000. The sale also set a cluster of new world auction records, among them Dana Schutz's *Elevator* (2017), which sold for HK$50,050,000; and Amoako Boafo's *Baba Diop* (2019), which soared above its high estimate of HK$1,500,000 before selling for HK$8,890,000.

Open link https://www.christies.com/lotfinder/paintings/henri-de-toulouse-lautrec-pierreuse-6301062-details.aspx?from=salesummery&intobjectid=6301062&lid=1&sc_lang=en

Henri de Toulouse-Lautrec (1864-1901), *Pierreuse*, 1889. Oil on canvas. 28¼ x 19⅛ in (71.7 x 48.5 cm). Sold for $9,062,000 on 2 December 2020 at Christie's in New York

1,733,906,375/224,706,473

Works offered in Hong Kong across five Modern and Contemporary Art Auctions in December achieved a combined total of HK$1,733,906,375 / US$224,706,473, a record-breaking result for Christie's Asia.

In addition to Sanyu's *Goldfish*, other notable results included Sanyu's *Pink Chrysanthemums in a Basket*, which sold for HK$138,110,000; and Zhang Xiaogang's *Bloodline Series The Big Family No.2*, which realised HK$98,035,000, setting a new world record for the artist at auction.

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